







PHISHING AWARENESS TRAINING – Behavioural



Study Estimated reading time:
20–25 minutes



Phishing Awareness Training

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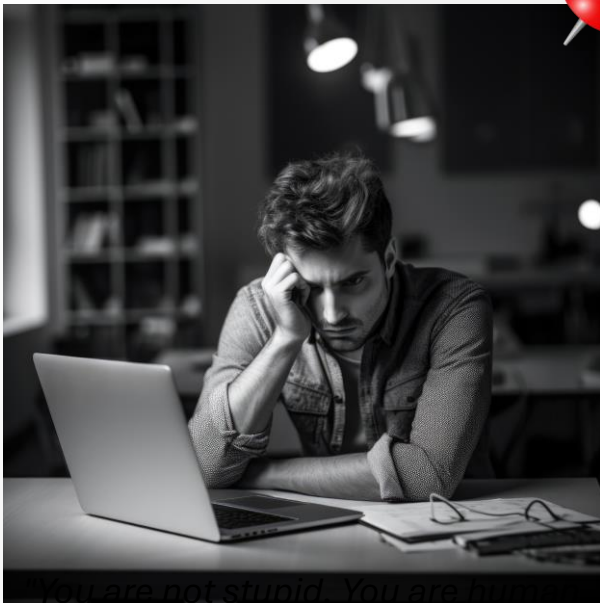
Module 05

YOUR PERSONAL 5-SECONDS
PHISHING CHECKLIST

MOUDLE 1

YOU JUST FELL FOR A PHISHING ATTACK
HERE IS WHY THAT IS COMPLETELY NORMAL.

YOU JUST FELL FOR A PHISHING
ATTACK. HERE IS WHY THAT IS
COMPLETELY NORMAL.



*"You are not stupid. You are human.
And phishing attacks are specifically
engineered to exploit the way human
brains work under pressure."*

Every single day, 3.4 billion phishing emails are sent worldwide. In 2024, phishing was responsible for 36% of all data breaches globally. The people who fall for them include doctors, lawyers, bank managers, IT professionals, even cybersecurity experts.

Why? Because modern phishing emails are NOT the badly spelled, obvious scams of the early 2000s. Today's attacks are:

- Personalised — they use your name, your company, your role
- Timed perfectly — sent when you are busy, stressed, or distracted
- Visually identical to real emails from trusted brands
- Emotionally engineered — they create urgency, fear, or curiosity

You did not fail. You were targeted. Now let's make sure it never works on you again.



MOUDLE 2

HOW TO DEEPLY INSPECT AN EMAIL BEFORE CLICKING ANYTHING



**THE GOLDEN RULE:
STOP — LOOK — VERIFY**

THE GOLDEN RULE: STOP — LOOK — VERIFY

Before clicking any link in any email, spend 30 seconds checking these 5 things:

CHECK 1 — THE SENDER'S EMAIL ADDRESS (Not just the display name)

This is the most important check of all. Attackers make the DISPLAY NAME look real but hide a fake email address behind it.

What you SEE: **IT Security Team**

What it REALLY IS: **it.security.alerts.notify@gmail.com**

How to check on your phone:

→ Gmail: Tap the sender's name → tap the actual email address shown below it

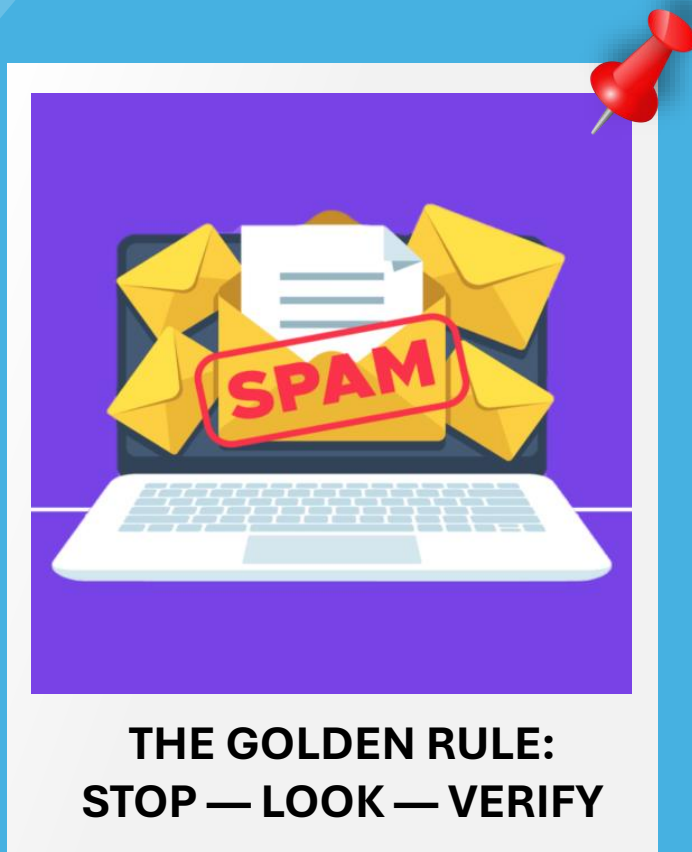
→ Outlook: Tap the name → "Show details"





MOUDLE 2

HOW TO DEEPLY INSPECT AN EMAIL
BEFORE CLICKING ANYTHING



**THE GOLDEN RULE:
STOP — LOOK — VERIFY**

What to look for:

- ✓ microsoft.com — REAL
- ✗ micros0ft.com — FAKE (zero instead of o)
- ✗ support-microsoft.com — FAKE (real Microsoft only uses microsoft.com)
- ✗ it.security1294@gmail.com — FAKE (legitimate companies do not use Gmail or numbers)
- ✗ microsoft.com.verify-login.ru — FAKE (the real domain is verify-login.ru)

**CHECK 2 — ⚠ NOT ALL PHISHING EMAILS GO TO SPAM
THIS IS THE MOST DANGEROUS MYTH**

Most people believe: "If it landed in my inbox, it must be safe."
**THIS IS WRONG. AND IT IS EXACTLY WHAT ATTACKERS
COUNT ON.**





MOUDLE 2

HOW TO DEEPLY INSPECT AN EMAIL BEFORE CLICKING ANYTHING



**THE GOLDEN RULE:
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CHECK 2 — ⚠️ NOT ALL PHISHING EMAILS GO TO SPAM THIS IS THE MOST DANGEROUS MYTH

Sophisticated phishing emails are crafted specifically to BYPASS spam filters and land directly in your inbox.

They do this by:

- Using legitimate email-sending services with good reputations
- Copying the exact HTML design of real company emails pixel-for-pixel
- Passing SPF, DKIM and DMARC email authentication checks
- Sending from newly registered domains not yet flagged as malicious
- Including real, legitimate links alongside the one malicious link

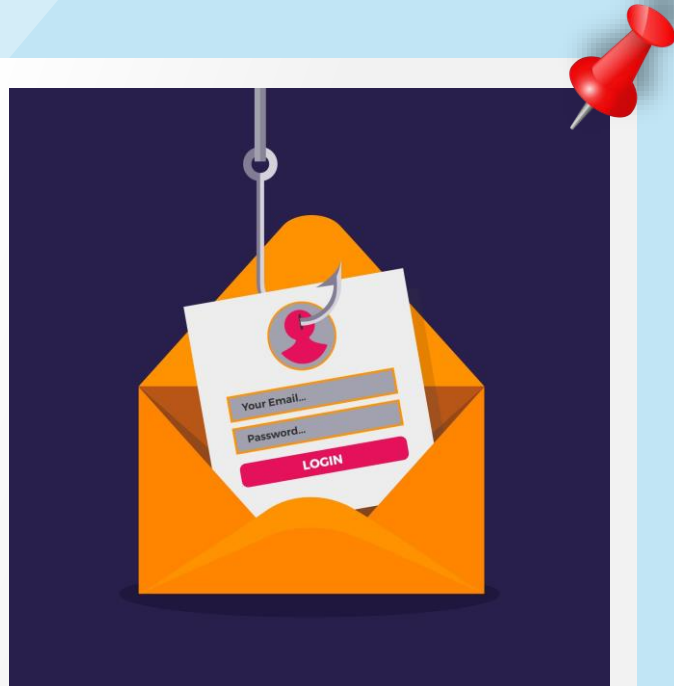
THE RULE: Spam folder = suspicious. Inbox = NOT automatically safe.

Every single email requires the same scrutiny regardless of where it lands.



MOUDLE 2

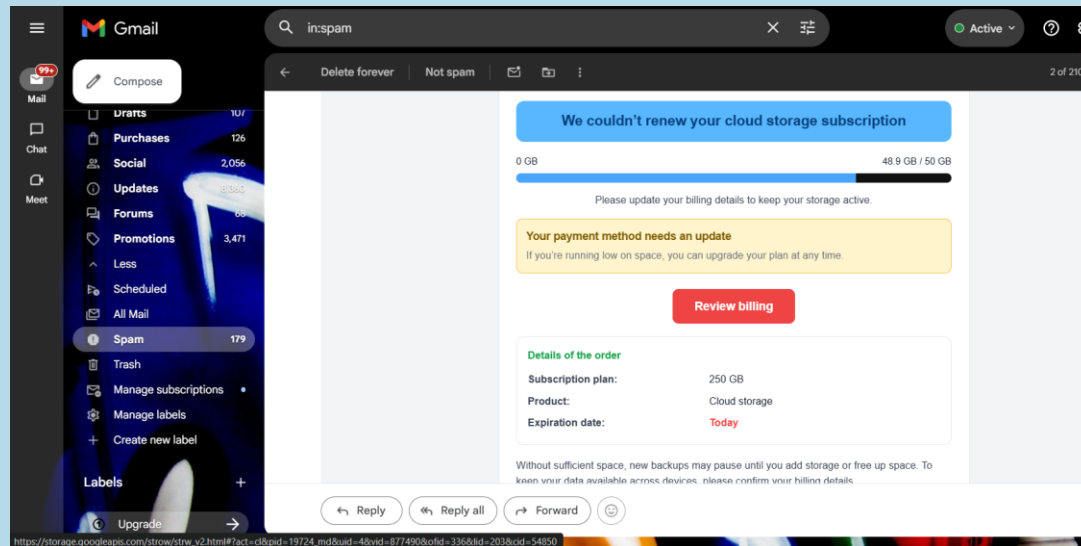
HOW TO DEEPLY INSPECT AN EMAIL BEFORE CLICKING ANYTHING



**THE GOLDEN RULE:
STOP — LOOK — VERIFY**

CHECK 3 — INSPECT THE LINK BEFORE YOU CLICK

On a **computer** — HOVER your mouse over the link without clicking. The real URL appears in the bottom left corner of your browser.



Check the lower left corner of the page for the fake embedded link





MOUDLE 2

HOW TO DEEPLY INSPECT AN EMAIL BEFORE CLICKING ANYTHING



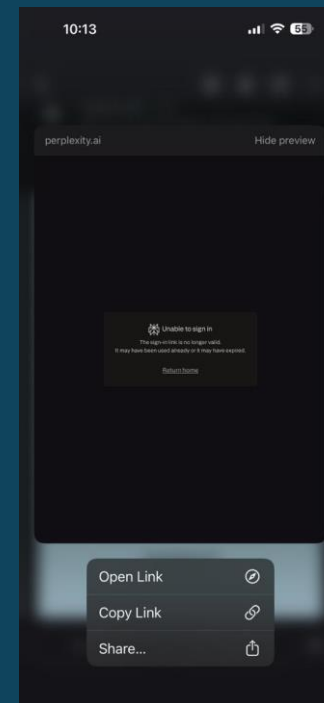
**THE GOLDEN RULE:
STOP — LOOK — VERIFY**

CHECK 3 — INSPECT THE LINK BEFORE YOU CLICK

On a phone — LONG PRESS the link (hold your finger down 2 seconds) on the link to see the real URL before it opens.

This is not a phishing email but a real email from perplexity.ai (address visible at the upper left side of the page)

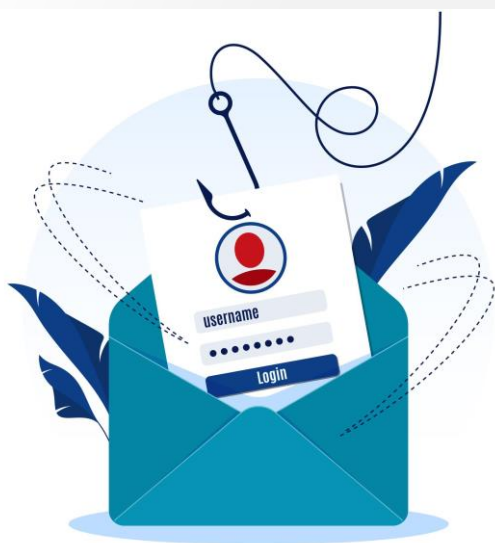
Most attackers sending phishing email hide/disable this to avoid victim from seeing the embedded fake link. Look out for that when inspecting the link. If after long press you cant see the link, verify through other means before clicking.





MOUDLE 2

HOW TO DEEPLY INSPECT AN EMAIL BEFORE CLICKING ANYTHING



**THE GOLDEN RULE:
STOP — LOOK — VERIFY**

RED FLAGS in URLs:

❌ **<http://192.168.0.190/login>** → An IP address instead of a domain name → Legitimate companies NEVER use IP addresses in links

❌ **<http://> instead of <https://>** → Notice the missing "s" after the HTTP, it means secured, when its not secured, it means it's not a real company website

❌ **microsofft-login.com** → Notice the double letter "f"— easy to miss when reading quickly

❌ **microsoft.com.account-verify.xyz** → The REAL domain here is account-verify.xyz → microsoft.com is just a subdomain being used to trick you

❌ **bit.ly/xK92mP or any shortened URL** → Always expand shortened links at checkshorturl.com before clicking





MOUDLE 2

HOW TO DEEPLY INSPECT AN EMAIL BEFORE CLICKING ANYTHING



**THE GOLDEN RULE:
STOP — LOOK — VERIFY**

CHECK 4 — RECOGNISE EMOTIONAL MANIPULATION

Phishing emails ALWAYS use emotional pressure. Here are the most common:

FEAR

"Your account has been compromised"

"Unauthorised access detected"

"Your account will be permanently deleted"

URGENCY

"You have 24 hours to verify"

"Immediate action required"

"Respond before midnight tonight"

AUTHORITY

"IT Security Department"

"HMRC Tax Refund"

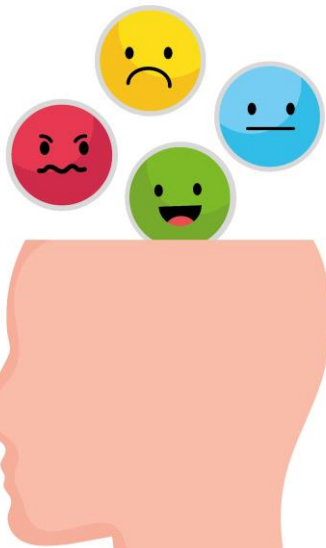
"Your Bank's Fraud Team"

"Your Manager" (BEC - Business Email Compromise)



MOUDLE 2

HOW TO DEEPLY INSPECT AN EMAIL BEFORE CLICKING ANYTHING



**THE GOLDEN RULE:
STOP — LOOK — VERIFY**

CURIOSITY

"You have a pending package"

"Someone shared a document with you"

"Your photo has been posted online"

REWARD

"You have been selected for a £500 refund"

"Congratulations - you have won"

THE RULE:

The more urgent and threatening an email feels, the **MORE** suspicious you should be.

Legitimate organisations do not:

- Threaten to delete your account within hours
- Ask for your password via email
- Send security alerts from Gmail or Yahoo addresses
- Pressure you to act before you have time to think





MOUDLE 2

HOW TO DEEPLY INSPECT AN EMAIL BEFORE CLICKING ANYTHING



**THE GOLDEN RULE:
STOP — LOOK — VERIFY**

CHECK 5 — WHEN IN DOUBT, GO DIRECTLY TO THE SOURCE

Never click a link in an email if you are unsure.
Instead - open a NEW browser tab and type the address
manually.

Example:

Email says → "Verify your Microsoft account now"

What to do

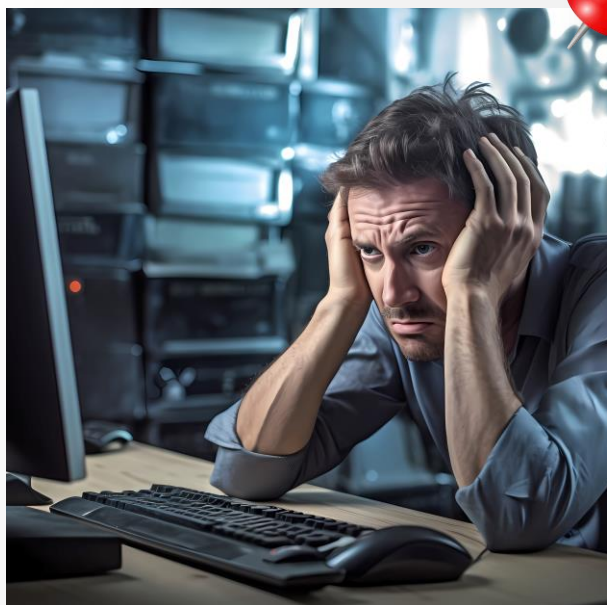
- Open browser → type microsoft.com
- log in yourself Result
- If there really is an alert, you will see it there If you log in directly and there is no alert, the email was fake. ✓





MOUDLE 3

WHAT TO DO IF YOU HAVE ALREADY
CLICKED



DO NOT PANIC.

Acting quickly limits the
damage significantly.

IF YOU CLICKED BUT DID NOT ENTER ANYTHING:

1. Close the tab immediately
2. Run a malware scan (Windows Defender / Malwarebytes)
3. Report to your IT or security team
4. Monitor your accounts for 48 hours for unusual activity

IF YOU ENTERED YOUR EMAIL AND PASSWORD:

Act within the next **5 MINUTES** if possible.

STEP 1 - Change your password **RIGHT AWAY**

- Go directly to the REAL website
(type it manually — do not use the email link)
- Change to a strong new password: 12+ characters,
letters + numbers + symbols





MOUDLE 3

WHAT TO DO IF YOU HAVE ALREADY CLICKED



DO NOT PANIC.

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damage significantly.

STEP 2 — Enable Two-Factor Authentication (2FA)
immediately

- Even if attackers have your password, 2FA blocks them from logging in
- Go to account security settings
- Enable Authenticator App
- Use Google Authenticator or Microsoft Authenticator (free)

STEP 3 — Check your recent login activity

- Gmail: scroll to bottom of inbox
- "Last account activity" at the lower right side of inbox page
- Click on Details just below it
- Microsoft: account.microsoft.com
- Sign-in activity
- Look for logins from unfamiliar countries or devices



MOUDLE 3

WHAT TO DO IF YOU HAVE ALREADY CLICKED



DO NOT PANIC.
Acting quickly limits the
damage significantly.

STEP 4 - Check if the same password is used on other sites

- If yes - change it on ALL of them immediately
- Start using a password manager: Bitwarden (free) so you never reuse passwords

STEP 5 - Report it

- Tell your organisation's IT/security team immediately
- Report to NCSC (UK): forward the email to report@phishing.gov.uk
- If bank or payment details were entered: call your bank immediately





MOUDLE 4

HOW TO INVESTIGATE A SUSPICIOUS LINK OR IP ADDRESS



**These are free tools
anyone can use**
no technical knowledge needed.

These are free tools anyone can use — no technical knowledge needed.

CHECK A LINK FOR MALWARE:

- Go to: [virustotal.com](https://www.virustotal.com) (owned by Google)
- Paste the suspicious URL
- click Scan
- Checks against 70+ security engines instantly, If 2 or more engines flag it, do not visit it

→ If zero engines flag it but the email still felt suspicious, verify directly by typing the address manually, brand new phishing domains are sometimes too new to be in any database yet.

Focus more on the detail section not score, it could show 0/91 score or state that “**No security vendors flagged this domain as malicious**” and still be dangerous, Check all the details deeply.





MOUDLE 4

HOW TO INVESTIGATE A SUSPICIOUS LINK OR IP ADDRESS



**These are free tools
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FIND OUT WHERE A LINK OR IP ADDRESS IS REALLY FROM:

- Go to: [iplocation.net](https://www.iplocation.net)
- Paste the IP address from the suspicious link
- It shows the country, city and company owning that server
- Country accuracy is 95–99% reliable

A "Microsoft" link pointing to a server owned by an unknown company in an unexpected country = red flag

Important: a UK or US server does not mean it is safe, always combine this with a VirusTotal scan





MOUDLE 4

HOW TO INVESTIGATE A SUSPICIOUS LINK OR IP ADDRESS



**These are free tools
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CHECK IF A DOMAIN WAS JUST CREATED (MAJOR RED FLAG):

- Go to: whois.domaintools.com
- Type the domain from the suspicious email
- Check the "Created" date. If Registered in the last few weeks or months, it's a major red flag and If the creation date is hidden or redacted, it's a yellow flag (legitimate companies rarely hide their domain registration)
- Real companies like Microsoft, HMRC and major banks have domains registered for many years or decades





MOUDLE 5

YOUR PERSONAL 5-SECONDS PHISHING CHECKLIST



**YOUR PERSONAL 5-SECOND
PHISHING CHECKLIST**

YOUR PERSONAL 5-SECONDS PHISHING CHECKLIST

Save this to your phone. Print it out. Make it a habit.

Before clicking ANY link in ANY email, ask:

1. Do I recognise the ACTUAL email address, not just the display name?
2. Was I expecting this email?
3. Does the link URL match the real company domain exactly?
4. Is this email creating urgency, fear, or pressure to act fast?
5. Can I verify this by going to the real website directly instead?

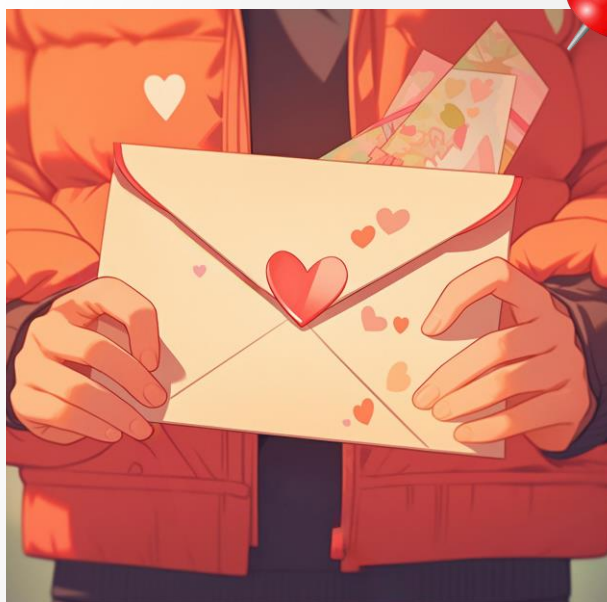
If ANY answer is NO or UNSURE → Do not click. Verify first.





MOUDLE 5

YOUR PERSONAL 5-SECONDS PHISHING CHECKLIST



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FINAL MESSAGE

"The fact that you clicked does not define you. The fact that you are here learning from it does."

You are now part of the most important line of defence in cybersecurity - an informed human being who knows what to look for. The most expensive security systems in the world are bypassed every single day because of one human click. Your awareness is now your strongest protection.

REMEMBER:

- Phishing lands in your INBOX - not just spam
 - Always check the REAL email address behind the name
 - Hover or long-press BEFORE you click any link
 - If you click by mistake - act fast, change passwords, enable 2FA
 - When in doubt - go directly to the website. Never through the email.
- Stay safe. Stay sceptical. Stay secure. 





THANK YOU

